
LEX LIGA MMXXVI

FUTSAL CHAMPIONSHIP

Lace up your boots and rally your squad — the turf is calling!



SPORTS AND CULTURAL COMMITTEE, SLFJPS

VENUE	Mess Ground
DATES	19th & 20th September 2026
FORMAT	Men / Women · 5v5 + 2 rolling substitutes

FOOTBALL RULE BOOK

Official regulations governing all matches of the tournament

Play Hard · Play Fair · Play Together

FOOTBALL RULE BOOK

1. Team Composition

- Each team shall consist of five (5) players on the field, including one goalkeeper.
- Each team may register a maximum of seven (7) players, in line with the 5v5 plus two (2) rolling-substitute format.
- Rolling substitutions are permitted throughout the game.
- A substitute must notify the sideline referee before entering. Entering early may result in a yellow card and an indirect free kick from the halfway line.
- Players must present their university ID before the match. First-year students without university ID must present their fee receipt and a valid government-issued identification document.
- Players must be fully kitted. If kit colours conflict, bibs shall be provided to one team.
- A team must have at least four (4) players to begin a match. Fewer than four players constitutes a forfeit.

2. Match Duration

- Each match shall consist of two (2) halves of eight (8) minutes each, with a three (3) minute halftime interval.
- Time runs continuously except for injuries, unexpected interruptions, disciplinary stoppages, or other circumstances at the referee's discretion.
- There are no timeouts. Time may be extended to allow a penalty kick to be completed.
- In knockout matches, a tied score after normal time shall be followed by extra time.
- If still tied, each team shall take five (5) penalties. If the scores remain tied, sudden death shall decide the winner.

3. Tournament Format

- The tournament will consist of a group stage followed by an eight-team knockout stage.
- The group stage shall consist of five groups. Each team plays one match against every other team in its group.
- The five group winners qualify automatically.
- The three best second-placed teams across all groups also qualify.
- Points: Win = 3, Draw = 1, Loss = 0.
- Tie-break order: goal difference, goals scored, goals conceded, then head-to-head result. If still unresolved, the organising committee shall apply a fair additional tie-break.
- The four quarter-final winners advance to the semi-finals.
- The two semi-final winners advance to the final.

4. Kickoff

- A coin toss determines which team kicks off and which team chooses ends. The team not taking the first kick-off starts the second half. A coin will additionally be tossed for bibs if needed at the discretion of the referee.
- The referee signals the start and restart after a goal with a kick from the centre.
- Players shall remain in their own half at kickoff. Opponents must be at least 5 yards from the ball until it is kicked.

5. General Play and Scoring

- There is no offside rule.
- A goal is scored when the whole ball crosses the goal line between the posts and under the crossbar.
- A goal may be scored directly from a corner kick and kickoff.
- A goal may not be scored directly against the opposing team from a goalkeeper's punt or dropkick.
- The ball is out of play when it completely crosses a goal line or sideline, or when the referee stops play.
- A ball striking a goal/corner post and remaining on the field remains in play.

6. Goal Kicks and Goalkeeper Rules

- For a goal kick, the ball may be placed anywhere in the goal-box area. Defenders must be outside the goal box.
- The ball is in play once touched by the kicker. The kicker cannot touch it again until another player has touched it.
- The goalkeeper has possession when touching the ball.
- A goalkeeper controlling the ball with the hands inside their penalty area must release it within six seconds.
- After releasing the ball, the goalkeeper may not handle it again until another player has touched it.
- The goalkeeper may not handle a ball kicked indirectly by a teammate or deliberately kicked back by a teammate. The restart is an indirect free kick.
- A goalkeeper shall not slide or dive feet-first or head-first while making a play. Such actions may be penalised as a slide tackle.
- A goalkeeper may change places with another player only when the official is informed and the change is made during a stoppage in play. A violation may result in a yellow card.
- Prohibited Landing: the ball cannot pitch or land for the first time on the opponent's half of the court if it was kicked directly from the goalkeeper's hands or feet from their own penalty area without touching the ground in the defensive half first.
- Allowed Bouncing Kicks: the goalkeeper can kick or throw the ball so that it first pitches (bounces or lands) on the floor anywhere inside their own defensive half before travelling across the halfway line.
- Restart of Play: if the goalkeeper kicks the ball directly over the halfway line in the air, violating the direct rule, the referee awards an indirect free kick to the opposing team from the halfway line at the spot where the ball crossed it.

7. Goal Box Rule

- If a handball occurs inside the box, the attacking team receives a direct penalty. Additionally, a card will be issued depending upon the severity of the offence.

8. Kick-ins

- When the ball completely crosses the sideline, the opposing team takes a kick-in from near where it left play.
- The ball must be placed on the ground and kicked into play. The kicker cannot touch it again until another player touches it.
- An improperly taken kick-in results in a restart for the opposing team.
- Opponents must not interfere with the kicker. Deliberate interference may result in a yellow card.

9. Corner Kicks

- A corner kick is awarded when the ball crosses the goal line after last touching a defending player.
- The ball must be placed on the ground within 1 yard of the corner flag or cone.
- Opponents must be at least 5 yards away when the corner is taken.
- The kicker cannot touch the ball again until another player has touched it.
- A goal may be scored directly from a corner kick.

10. Free Kicks

- All dead-ball kicks that include kick-ins, indirect free kicks and kickoffs, are indirect.
- All dead-ball kicks that include corner kicks, penalty kicks and other free kicks are direct.
- The free kick may be taken by any player of the offended team on the field at the time of the offence.
- Players must follow any minimum distance as directed by the referee.

11. Penalty Kicks

- A penalty kick is awarded for a serious or intentional rule infraction by the defending team inside the penalty area, except an offence requiring an indirect free kick.
- The penalty may be taken by any player of the offended team who was on the field at the time of the offence.
- All penalties are one-step penalties.
- The opposing goalkeeper may move laterally along the goal line between the goalposts until the ball is kicked.

12. Temporary Suspension and Injury

- If play is temporarily suspended for injury or an unexpected interruption, the team clearly in possession shall receive an indirect free kick from the spot where the ball was, except where another restart is required.

- If neither team was clearly in possession, the referee shall use a dropped ball at the location of the ball when play was suspended.
- During an injury, both teams may substitute openly, subject to the seven-player roster limit.

13. Cards and Disciplinary Rules

- Yellow Card: the player serves a one-minute suspension and the team plays with one fewer player during the suspension.
- Red Card: the player is dismissed for the remainder of the match and suspension for additional matches as decided after review.
- Two yellow cards in the same match constitute a red card.
- The referee may impose additional suspensions or penalties for serious misconduct.

14. Fouls

- Charging, handballs, holding, pushing, tripping, obstruction, delay of game and similar offences may result in the appropriate card and direct or indirect free kick.
- The referee may stop play for dangerous play or actions that threaten player safety.

15. Sportsmanship

- Players must maintain good conduct and sportsmanship throughout the tournament.
- Abusive, threatening, violent, discriminatory or deliberately dangerous behaviour may result in dismissal, suspension or team disqualification.
- The referees' decisions are final and must be respected at all times.

16. Final Authority

- Standard football rules apply unless specifically modified by this rulebook.
- In cases of ambiguity, the referee's decision shall be final.
- The organising committee reserves the right to clarify administrative matters before or during the tournament where necessary.